

## Week 2 — Strategic Design & Metrics

*"If you cannot measure what 'better' looks like, you are not doing strategy. You are doing wishful feature delivery."*

Week 2 converts the customer understanding built in Week 1 into something **measurable, designable, and prioritized**. Every triad arrives Monday with a problem statement; they leave Friday with a strategy & metrics package they can defend in front of an engineering lead.

Triads from Week 1 persist (they carry the mini-capstone in Week 3). The shared **FieldPulse** case continues — by Friday, each triad's package is grounded in FieldPulse evidence.

### Learning outcomes

By Friday afternoon, each participant can:

1. Distinguish operational signals, KPIs, and a North Star — and explain how a change in one is supposed to ripple to the others.
2. Propose a North Star metric for a product and defend it against three standard pitfalls (vanity metric, leading-indicator confusion, gameable targets).
3. Apply core UX heuristics (Nielsen's 10, accessibility minimums) to audit a real product surface and produce a short list of design principles a TPM-engineer pair can ship against.
4. Use AI to compile a multi-source research summary with evidence tagging, and detect when the AI is over-confident relative to its inputs.
5. Build a customer journey map that connects observed pain points (from Week 1) to a prioritized list of feature concepts.

### Daily map

| DAY | TOPIC                                      | KEY ARTIFACT PRODUCED                                         |
|-----|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1   | Operational signals & KPIs                 | Metrics tier sheet (triad)                                    |
| 2   | Defining the North Star metric             | North Star proposal + supporting metrics (triad)              |
| 3   | Product design & UX principles             | UX audit + 3 design principles (triad)                        |
| 4   | Using AI for strategy & research summaries | AI-assembled strategy brief (triad)                           |
| 5   | Customer journey mapping                   | Journey map + prioritized feature concepts (triad, presented) |

Each day's artifact feeds the next. Friday readouts are the seed of every triad's Week 3 PRD.

## Daily cadence (applies every day)

| CLOCK         | BLOCK                                           | MIX                                           |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 09:00 – 09:15 | Opening & objectives                            | Instructor                                    |
| 09:15 – 10:30 | Teaching Block 1 + Activity 1                   | ~25 min teach / 50 min group                  |
| 10:30 – 10:45 | <b>Break</b>                                    |                                               |
| 10:45 – 12:00 | Teaching Block 2 + Activity 2                   | ~25 min teach / 50 min group                  |
| 12:00 – 13:00 | <b>Lunch</b>                                    |                                               |
| 13:00 – 14:15 | Teaching Block 3 + Activity 3                   | ~25 min teach / 50 min group                  |
| 14:15 – 14:30 | <b>Break</b>                                    |                                               |
| 14:30 – 16:00 | Teaching Block 4 + Activity 4 + Readouts + Wrap | ~25 min teach / 45 min group / 20 min readout |

**Group composition:** triads carry over from Week 1. If a participant joined late, place them in the smallest existing triad rather than forming new groups.

## Materials referenced across the week

- `day-01-metrics-kpis.md` — Metrics Tier Sheet, vanity-metric examples
- `day-02-north-star.md` — North Star pitfalls card, candidate-evaluation rubric
- `day-03-design-ux.md` — UX heuristics card, audit template
- `day-04-ai-research-summaries.md` — Strategy brief template, evidence-tag schema
- `day-05-journey-mapping.md` — Journey map canvas, feature-prioritization frame

## Week 2 readout rubric (Friday afternoon)

Each triad presents a **12-minute integrated strategy package**: North Star → supporting metrics → 1 design principle → journey map → top 3 feature concepts. Peer and instructor score on:

| DIMENSION           | WEIGHT | WHAT "EXEMPLARY" LOOKS LIKE                                                                                          |
|---------------------|--------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Metric coherence    | 25%    | NS, KPIs, and operational signals form a believable causal chain — change in operational signal plausibly ripples up |
| North Star defense  | 20%    | Triad can name and rebut three pitfalls applied to their own NS                                                      |
| Journey realism     | 20%    | Journey map references observed Week-1 pain points; not generic                                                      |
| Feature linkage     | 15%    | Each top feature ties to a specific journey friction point AND a metric it would move                                |
| AI-use transparency | 10%    | Where AI summarized research, prompts and validation steps are disclosed                                             |
| Design awareness    | 10%    | At least one UX principle is named and its trade-off acknowledged                                                    |

## Bridge to Week 3

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Week 3 turns each triad's strategy package into a **Technical PRD** — Acceptance Criteria, Non-Functional Requirements, and a non-AI mini-capstone. The journey map and prioritized feature concepts produced Friday of Week 2 are the **direct input** to Monday's PRD drafting in Week 3. Do not let triads leave Friday without those two artifacts in shareable form.